

Research & Documentation

Project Overview

StoryCast is a three-page accessible microsite that showcases audio and video storytelling. It features four real media pieces, a Kenyan environmental documentary, a TED talk on memory and neuroscience, an NHS night shift documentary, and a Nigerian radio discussion on the Lagos power crisis. The project was built without any CSS or JavaScript frameworks using semantic HTML5, Sass, and vanilla JavaScript. Every piece of media is accompanied by a full transcript or captions, and the site meets WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standards throughout.

Information Architecture

Sitemap

```
Home (index.html)
├─ Voices of the Earth (story/voices-from-the-valley.html)
├─ The Cartographers of Memory (story/cartographers-of-memory.html)
├─ The Night Shift at the Clinic (story/night-shift-at-the-clinic.html)
├─ Lagos Power Outages (story/radio-discussion.html)
└─ About & Access (about.html)
```

Page purposes

- *Home*: introduces the platform, featured story, story grid, newsletter
- *Story pages*: media player, timed transcript, related stories sidebar
- *About & Access*: mission, accessibility features, team

Design Decisions

The site uses a dark broadcast-inspired palette with near black backgrounds and warm amber accents, chosen to reflect the mood of documentary and radio media. All text contrast ratios exceed WCAG AA requirements, body text achieves 16.2:1, amber links 8.1:1, and secondary text 5.8:1. For typography, Playfair Display was chosen for headings to bring an editorial, storytelling quality, Inter for body text for its screen legibility, and JetBrains Mono for timestamps and metadata to keep transcript cues scannable and aligned. The layout uses CSS Grid for page-level structure and Flexbox for component alignment, with a container query on the story card grid that switches cards from a vertical to a horizontal layout when their container drops below 480px.

Accessibility

- Skip link on every page
- All media wrapped in `<figure>` with `<figcaption>`

- Audio stories have full timed transcripts
- Video has WebVTT captions via <track> element
- aria-expanded, aria-current, aria-label used throughout
- Visible focus ring (:focus-visible) on all interactive elements
- prefers-reduced-motion disables animations

Sass Structure

```
sass/  
├─ main.scss  
└─ partials/  
    ├── _colors.scss  
    ├── _typography.scss  
    ├── _spacing.scss  
    ├── _reset.scss  
    └─ _components.scss
```

To run locally, open <http://localhost:5500>, or use VS Code Live Server.

To recompile Sass: `sass --watch sass/main.scss css/main.css`

Github Repository: <https://github.com/aimelive/StoryCast.git>

High fidelity figma mockup:

<https://www.figma.com/design/y2E5ca7WhjHyM9UsTDuzSG/Story-Cast?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=≡YvQ68yx6n5x0X61D-0>

Sitemap:

<https://www.figma.com/board/uax0wkTKs0mSB9jm1GilGK/story-cast?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=hDvq2yy7jAYzesNZ-0>